FREE GUIDE · VA CHALLENGES EP 4

Time Trackers: Work With Monitoring the Right Way

Many clients and agencies track screenshots and activity. Know how it works so your pay is protected.

Upwork Work Diary basics	What it means
6 screenshots per hour	Keep only client work on screen
Activity per 10-minute segment	Counts clicks, scrolls and keystrokes, not what you typed
Memos	Describe the work in every session
Weekly limit	Hours above the limit may not be protected

Upwork says time may not qualify for Hourly Payment Protection if it shows

- ☐ Manual time entries
- ☐ Idle or empty activity
- ☐ Hours beyond the weekly limit
- ☐ Non-work activity, or missing or unclear memos

Source: Upwork Help Center, "How to manage your work diary on Upwork". Check the latest rules on Upwork.

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Fair monitoring and questions to ask

Talk about tracking before you sign, not after.

Fair	Not fair
Written in the agreement	Tracking after your shift ends
Only shift hours are tracked	Webcam always on with no reason
A way to bill meetings and calls	Pay cut for thinking or call time
Manual time agreed in writing	Tracking never explained

Ask before you sign

☐ Which tracker, and what does it record?
☐ When should it be on or off?
☐ How are meetings and research paid?
☐ Who can see the screenshots?

Clean record habits

☐ Separate browser profile for client work
☐ Pause the tracker on breaks
☐ Never use mouse jigglers or fake activity
☐ Tell the client about calls that will not show on screen